

ACCESSIBILITY CONFORMANCE REPORT

ADA Title II Accessibility Audit

City of Colorado Springs — coloradosprings.gov

Police Executive Research Forum (PERF) Study of CSPD Training

AUDIT DATE	May 24, 2026
CONFORMANCE TARGET	WCAG 2.1 Level AA
REGULATORY BASIS	ADA Title II — the U.S. DOJ 2024 web rule adopts WCAG 2.1 AA for state & local government content
PAGE AUDITED	coloradosprings.gov/police-executive-research-forum-study-cspd-training
METHOD	Manual code & assistive-technology review (markup, ARIA, tables, media, links, focus)
REPORT STATUS	Final

About this report. This audit assesses the City of Colorado Springs “PERF Study of CSPD Training” page against WCAG 2.1 success criteria. Each finding is classified by severity, mapped to its governing criterion, and paired with a concrete remediation. Several findings live in shared content-management templates (the header navigation, footer navigation, alert carousel, and search modal) and recur across the municipal site — fixing those in the templates corrects every page that reuses them.

Executive Summary

The page rests on a solid accessibility foundation: a working skip link as the first focusable element, a declared page language, correct landmark structure, labeled search-dialog fields, meaningful `alt` text on every image, a properly labeled breadcrumb, and no duplicate IDs. The inclusion of a sign-language interpreter in the video is a genuine good practice.

However, the review identified **nine confirmed WCAG 2.1 AA failures and five best-practice concerns**. The highest-impact failures are a data table published with no header cells (leaving screen-reader users without column context), an embedded video with a non-descriptive frame title and no on-page transcript or confirmed captions, and eleven links that open new tabs with no warning. The remainder concern landmark labeling, carousel and search controls, and heading structure.

None require redesign; all are remediable with targeted markup, ARIA, and content additions, most rated low effort. Because the navigation, footer, carousel, and search components are shared CMS templates, correcting them once propagates the fix across the city site.

Findings at a Glance



Severity reflects user impact and whether the issue is a confirmed failure or a risk/best-practice item, not engineering effort — nearly all items are low-to-moderate effort.

Severity Definitions

SEVERITY	MEANING
Critical	A confirmed WCAG 2.1 AA failure that creates a barrier for assistive-technology or keyboard users. Fix first.
Moderate	A best-practice gap, AA risk, or item requiring verification that degrades or may degrade the experience but generally has a workaround.

SECTION 2

Detailed Findings

PERF / CSPD Training page · 14 findings · 9 Critical · 5 Moderate

What's Working Well

- ✓ **Skip link first.** “Skip to main content” is the first focusable element on the page.
- ✓ **Language declared.** `<html lang="en">` is correctly set.
- ✓ **Meaningful image alternatives.** Every `<img>` carries non-empty, descriptive `alt` text, including the App Store / Google Play badges.
- ✓ **Labeled search fields.** The search-dialog text input and selects are associated with `<label>` elements.
- ✓ **Labeled breadcrumb.** The breadcrumb navigation uses `aria-label="breadcrumb"`.
- ✓ **Correct landmarks.** `<main>`, banner header, and `contentinfo` footer are present and used appropriately.
- ✓ **No duplicate IDs.** None were detected on the page.
- ✓ **Accessible language selector.** A native `<select>` with a visible label.
- ✓ **Social links have text.** Facebook, Twitter, Instagram, and YouTube links include visible text labels.
- ✓ **Policy links describe type.** DMCA and Privacy links carry `aria-label`s noting they are PDFs.
- ✓ **Inclusive media.** A sign-language interpreter is visible in the video — a positive accessibility practice.

• Critical — WCAG 2.1 AA Failures

1 “Timeline of the Project” table has no header cells

The data table uses only `<td>` elements across all ten rows — no `<th>`, no `<thead>`, no `<caption>`. Screen-reader users hear raw cell values with no column context, unable to tell a date from a description.

Fix: Add `<th scope="col">` headers (e.g. “Date,” “Event”), wrap them in `<thead>`, and add a `<caption>` describing the table's purpose.

WCAG 1.3.1

Effort: Low

2 Skip-link target is not a focusable landmark

The skip link targets `#main-content`, which resolves to an empty `<a tabindex="-1">` rather than the `<main>` element (which has no `id`). The link works in principle, but this anchor workaround is fragile and some browser/AT combinations fail to move focus correctly.

Fix: Put `id="main-content"` directly on the `<main>` element (add `tabindex="-1"` to it) and remove the redundant anchor.

WCAG 2.4.1

Effort: Low

3 Embedded video has a non-descriptive frame title

The Vimeo `<iframe>` uses `title="Perf - Public"` — the text assistive technology announces when focus enters the frame. It is not meaningful to users.

Fix: Use a descriptive title such as `title="Public Presentation Recording – PERF Study of CSPD Training"`.

WCAG 1.1.1 / 4.1.2

Effort: Low

4 Video captions unverified and no transcript provided

The video is embedded with no page-level transcript and no confirmation that accurate captions are enabled in the player. Prerecorded audio-visual content requires synchronized captions, and a transcript is a valuable equivalent.

Fix: Confirm accurate captions are enabled in Vimeo, and provide (or link) a text transcript on the page.

WCAG 1.2.2

Effort: Medium

5 Eleven links open new tabs with no warning (and no `rel`)

Eleven links use `target="_blank"` with no indication that a new window will open, and none include `rel="noopener noreferrer"`. Affected links include “Download the Report Here,” “City Code, Charter,” “Subscribe,” the social-media links, and the DMCA/Privacy links.

Fix: Add visible text or a visually-hidden / `aria-label` “(opens in new tab)” to each, and add `rel="noopener noreferrer"` for security.

WCAG 3.2.2 / 2.4.4

Effort: Low

6 PDF link gives no file-type, size, or new-tab warning

“Download the Report Here” opens a PDF in a new tab with nothing in the link text or `aria-label` signaling the format, size, or new window.

Fix: Update the accessible name to e.g. “Download the PERF CSPD Training Report (PDF, opens in new tab)”.

WCAG 2.4.4

Effort: Low

7 Carousel “Previous / Next / Play-Pause” controls lack accessible names

The header contains two sets of carousel controls rendered as `<a href="#">` with only the text “Previous,” “Next,” and “Play/Pause.” Nothing indicates which carousel they control, making them ambiguous in a link list.

Fix: Add descriptive `aria-label`s such as “Previous alert,” “Next alert,” “Pause alerts slideshow.”

WCAG 4.1.2

Effort: Low

8 Primary navigation has no accessible label

Of the four `<nav>` landmarks, three are labeled but the primary (hamburger) navigation has no `aria-label` or `aria-labelledby`, so screen-reader users meet an unlabeled navigation region.

Fix: Add `aria-label="Main navigation"` to the primary `<nav>`.

WCAG 1.3.1 / 2.4.6

Effort: Low

9 Two footer navs reference empty label elements

Two footer `<nav>` elements use `aria-labelledby` pointing at IDs (`menu-quick-links-title`, `menu-footer-title`) that resolve to empty strings, so they are announced as unlabeled.

Fix: Populate the referenced elements with visible text, or switch to explicit `aria-label` values such as “Quick Links” and “Footer Navigation.”

WCAG 4.1.2

Effort: Low

• Moderate — Best Practice / AA Risk

10 Search control naming and modal focus management

The search toggle (`id="search-form-icon"`) has no `aria-label` or `title` ; its name comes from a generic span. When hidden, the search dialog is marked `aria-hidden="true"` yet still contains five focusable elements, which can trap keyboard focus in an invisible region.

Fix: Give the toggle `aria-label="Open search"` . While hidden, make child controls unfocusable (`inert` or `tabindex="-1"`); while open, remove `aria-hidden` .

WCAG 4.1.2

Effort: Medium

11 Page title duplicated as both H1 and H2; no structural mid-level

The title appears as the banner `<h1>` and again as an `<h2>` at the top of the article, with all section headings below at `<h3>` . The outline runs H1 → H2 (duplicate) → H3, where the H2 serves no structural purpose.

Fix: Remove the duplicate article `<h2>` (the banner H1 suffices), or make the H2 a meaningful parent section heading with H3s beneath it.

WCAG 2.4.6

Effort: Low

12 External link to [policeforum.org](http://www.policeforum.org) gives no leaving-site cue

The link to `www.policeforum.org` opens in the same tab (acceptable) but has no `title` , `aria-label` , or visual indicator that it leaves the city domain — and it shows an abbreviated URL.

Fix: Add `aria-label="Police Executive Research Forum website (external link)"` or a visible “(external link)” cue.

WCAG 2.4.4 · Best practice

Effort: Low

13 Confirm whether the hero banner image is informational

The hero photo (police vehicle) appears to be a CSS background image, invisible to assistive technology. That is correct *if* the image is decorative; if it conveys meaning, it is currently missing from the accessibility tree.

Fix: Confirm the image’s purpose. If informational, implement it as an `<img>` with descriptive `alt` text; if decorative, the background approach is fine.

WCAG 1.1.1 · verify

Effort: Low

14 Verify the alert-banner icon is purely decorative

The warning-triangle icon in the Alerts banner is an SVG with `aria-hidden="true"`. That is appropriate because the bold “ALERTS” text supplies context — provided the icon is not the sole indicator of urgency.

Fix: Confirm the adjacent “ALERTS” text fully conveys the meaning; if so, no change is needed.

WCAG 1.1.1 · verify

Effort: Low

SECTION 3

Recommended Remediation Order

This sequence follows the audit's own priority guidance: resolve the confirmed barriers that most affect comprehension and navigation first, then the labeling and control items, then the verification / best-practice items. Several entries touch shared CMS templates and clear multiple pages at once.

Primary remediation queue

ORDER	ID	ACTION	WCAG	EFFORT
1	1	Add headers, <code><thead></code> , and a caption to the timeline table	1.3.1	Low
2	3	Give the video a descriptive frame title	1.1.1 / 4.1.2	Low
3	4	Verify captions and add a transcript	1.2.2	Medium
4	5, 6	Warn on new-tab links; label the PDF; add <code>rel</code>	3.2.2 / 2.4.4	Low
5	2	Make <code><main></code> the real skip-link target	2.4.1	Low
6	8	Label the primary navigation	1.3.1 / 2.4.6	Low
7	9	Fix the empty footer-nav label targets	4.1.2	Low
8	7	Name the carousel controls	4.1.2	Low
9	10	Name the search toggle; fix hidden-modal focus	4.1.2	Medium
10	11	Resolve the duplicate-title heading hierarchy	2.4.6	Low

Verification & best-practice items

ID	ACTION	WCAG	EFFORT
12	Add an external-link cue to the policeforum.org link	2.4.4	Low
13	Confirm hero-image purpose; convert to <code></code> if informational	1.1.1	Low
14	Confirm the alert icon is decorative	1.1.1	Low

SECTION 4

Ongoing Testing Program

This was a manual, code- and AT-level review of a single page. Because the page reuses city-wide CMS components, pair automated scanning with manual testing and verify shared-template fixes across multiple pages.

LAYER	RECOMMENDED PRACTICE
Automated scanning	Run axe DevTools, WAVE, or axe-core in CI on this page and on every page reusing the shared header, footer, carousel, and search components. Treat new violations as build-blocking regressions.
Table & structure	After the Finding 1 fix, navigate the timeline table by row/column with a screen reader to confirm header association, and re-inspect the heading outline for a single <code><h1></code> and logical levels.
Media	Play the video with captions on; review the transcript for accuracy and completeness, including speaker identification.
Keyboard & focus	Tab through the carousel and the open/closed search modal to confirm visible focus, no focus trapped in hidden regions, and a working skip link to <code><main></code> .
Link audit	Confirm every new-tab link announces the behavior and carries <code>rel="noopener noreferrer"</code> , and that file links state their format.

Scope & disclaimer. This report reflects a point-in-time review of the City of Colorado Springs “PERF Study of CSPD Training” page as observed on the audit date. It does not constitute legal advice or a certification of compliance. WCAG conformance is determined per page and per process; remediating the findings herein advances — but does not by itself guarantee — full WCAG 2.1 AA or ADA Title II conformance across the site. Re-test after remediation and extend coverage to other templated pages and to any linked documents (including the report PDF).